



Humbling defeat: India was thrashed by an innings and 32 runs by South Africa in the first Test in Centurion. GETTY IMAGES

on slow pitches. Even if that is true, isn't it better to get into a rhythm against such opposition than stay at home? Not only the batters can get some runs under their belts, but the bowlers can also go flat out and test themselves.

With the relations between the two boards being good, it would make sense if the Indian cricket board wrote to its counterpart and asked for matches against their national champions or the 'A' team before the first Test. Then, in the week or so gap between the

second and third Tests and between the fourth and fifth Tests, there could be another game so that the reserve players get to show their mettle. **Those who haven't gotten wickets or tons in the earlier Tests will also have an opportunity to get their form and rhythm back for the Tests to follow.** The time to give in to what the seniors want is gone, for there have been no positive results. It's time to simply think of the best for Indian cricket and not what suits a few individuals, however great they may be.

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